

Letter of Recommendation

Date: 28/04/2026

To the Selection Committee,
PURE Program, Sabanci University, Istanbul, Turkey

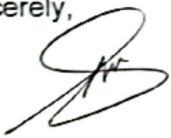
I have known Shafikul Islam Marwan as a student in the Department of Computer Science and Engineering at Jashore University of Science and Technology for multiple semesters, including in my courses on Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning. In that time, he has been one of the more attentive and genuinely curious students I have taught. He holds a CGPA of 3.78 out of 4.00 (up to 3rd semester), which places him among the stronger students in his batch, but what stands out more than the number is how he engages. He listens carefully, picks up new concepts faster than most, and has a habit of coming back with questions that show he has thought about the material after class rather than simply noting it down.

Outside the classroom, Marwan has put in a serious amount of independent work. He has solved more than 2,100 data structure and algorithm problems across platforms including Codeforces, LeetCode, CodeChef, CSES, and VJudge, participated in over 100 programming contests, and won the JUST intra-University Programming Contest in 2025. I find this significant not just as a list of accomplishments but because of what it takes to build that kind of record alongside a full academic schedule. It requires patience, self-discipline, and the ability to stay focused through repeated difficulty. These are exactly the qualities that matter in a research setting, and Marwan has demonstrated them consistently.

He has also independently built and deployed two complete machine learning applications: an insurance premium prediction system using Python, scikit-learn, FastAPI, and Streamlit, and a personality classifier trained on behavioral data that achieved 92.93% test accuracy and is live on Hugging Face Spaces. For a student who has not yet had formal research experience, this is a meaningful level of independent capability. He did not just learn the techniques; he built working systems with them.

I believe Marwan is genuinely ready for a structured research experience, and the PURE program is the right next step for him. He has the technical foundation, the work ethic, and the character to contribute meaningfully to a research group. I recommend him with full confidence.

Sincerely,



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